Sofia's Solo Playbook

105 days to Winter Formal

Stay a Little Longer · Lyrical · Choreography by Hannah · Rehearsals with Ms. Brittany · Winter Formal Sat Jan 9, 2027

My music map (track is 2:04)

SOFT 0:00–0:48 · the "feel it" half	FULL 0:48–1:52 · the tricks half	fade

The big beat lands about every 2.3 seconds in the loud half. Finish every shape **on** the beat, not a hair after. The music is fully gone at **2:00**: hold the last shape until then.

Where the big moments land

~0:11	Floor drop, seated fold
~0:15	Side-sit leg reach (leg to ceiling)
~0:34	Attitude, arms up
0:48	**Music swells**
~0:50	Cartwheel — right on the swell
~1:08	Walkover / handstand line
~1:42	Floor kick
~1:50	Passé turns
1:53–2:00	Floor ending — **hold it**

My superpowers (already strong!)

- Smooth floor work: no crashing in or out
- Big full-body reach on the lunge
- Brave acro: cartwheel, walkover, clean handstand line
- Straight standing leg in attitude and passé

My fixes (the picture judges see)

- ☐ **Point + straighten.** Every floor extension: knee straight, foot pointed. Side-sit reach too.
- ☐ **Side leg: pick one.** Clean attitude or straight. Never halfway.
- ☐ **Eyes up.** No mirror, no Hannah. Every section has a spot to look at.
- ☐ **Long arms.** Elbows straight overhead, shoulders down.
- ☐ **Passé high.** Toe to the side of the knee, up on relevé, sharp spot.
- ☐ **Trick prep is dancing.** Don't drop your head early before the cartwheel.
- ☐ **Donut roll:** arms down, head ALL the way back. Never tuck the chin (Hannah).
- ☐ **Hold the ending** until the music is gone at 2:00.

Where do I look? (fill in with Ms. Brittany)

Section	My focal point
Opening walk	
Floor work	
Attitude / standing	
Cartwheel → walkover	
Floor kick / turns	
Ending	

Ms. Brittany's top 3 right now

Practice at home

Thu · Fri · Sun at home (30–40 min) · Wed 3:30–4:00 solo rehearsal with Ms. Brittany · Mon & Tue = rest

The routine (check them off)

WARM UP 5 min

- [ ] Jumping jacks, arm circles, leg swings

STRONG 10 min

- [ ] Hollow hold + superman 3×20 sec
- [ ] Plank + side plank 2×20–30 sec
- [ ] Slow relevés 2×15 · one-leg balance 20 sec each
- [ ] Lying leg lifts, straight knee, 2×10 each side

BENDY 10 min · after warm-up only

- [ ] Right, left, middle split + straddle, 20–30 sec each

TECHNIQUE 10 min

- [ ] Passé balance on relevé 5–10 sec, both sides
- [ ] 10 single pirouettes each side, spot!
- [ ] Kicks to hip height: straight knee, pointed foot
- [ ] Arms overhead in the mirror: long elbows

THE DANCE 5 min

- [ ] Mark it once, then FULL OUT once, eyes up
- [ ] Sunday: film it. Watch. Pick ONE fix. Say one thing you loved.

The road to January 8

1. **Own it** · Sep 28–Oct 25
   Whole solo with NO cues by Oct 18. Build strength + bendy base. Mark the trio weekly.
2. **Clean it** · Oct 26–Nov 29
   Pointed feet, straight knees, long arms, high passé. Trick preps look like dancing. Light week at Thanksgiving.
3. **Perform it** · Nov 30–Jan 2
   Eyes up with focal points. Two full-out runs back to back on Sundays. Costume on twice in December. Hold the ending to 2:00.
4. **Taper** · Jan 3–8
   One run a day, no new skills, no deep stretching. Mini show for family Thu Jan 7. Early bedtime.

After the Formal: Press Play (classes only, Jan 15–17) → Hollywood Connection Jan 22–24 → Ryze Feb 19–21 → ID Feb 26–28 → Hollywood Vibe Apr 30–May 2.

Say it before every run

Point. Straighten. Eyes up.
Long arms. Hit the beat. Hold the end.

Rules that keep me dancing

- Warm up before stretching. A stretch feels like a stretch, never pain.
- No oversplits. No bridges unless Hannah says yes.
- Acro at home only on the mat or with a spotter.
- If it hurts, stop. Sleep and water are part of training.

Practice tracker · color a box for every session

Week of	Thu	Fri	Sun	Filmed?	This week's one fix
Sep 28					
Oct 5					
Oct 12					
Oct 19 · no cues!					
Oct 26					
Nov 2					
Nov 9					
Nov 16					
Nov 23 · light					
Nov 30					
Dec 7					
Dec 14 · costume					
Dec 21					
Dec 28					
Jan 4 · taper					SHOWS JAN 8-10

My tricks: how to make each one better

One trick per Friday. Rotate through all eight, then start again. Warm up first, every time.

1 · Side-sit leg reach (~0:15)

Goal: leg straight up, foot pointed, chest lifted.

- [ ] Sit on one hip, hand on floor. Leg straight up: 4 up, hold 2, 4 down. 6 each side.
- [ ] Arm slides up the leg, past the toes.
- [ ] Cue: **push the floor, reach the toe. Knee straight on the way down.**

2 · Side extension / attitude (~0:34)

Goal: one clear shape, never halfway. Ask Ms. Brittany: attitude or straight?

- [ ] At a counter: développé side, 4 counts up, hold 2, 4 counts down. 6 each side.
- [ ] Side-lying leg lifts, pointed foot, 2×12 each side.
- [ ] Standing leg: heel presses **down**, knee straight, hip stays square.

3 · Cartwheel on the swell (~0:50)

Goal: it looks like dancing, not a setup, and it lands on the beat.

- [ ] Drill the 4 counts **before** it: reach, look, place. Head stays up until hands go down.
- [ ] Cartwheel over a tape line on the floor: legs pass straight through vertical.
- [ ] Land + arm finish exactly on the beat. Play the track from 0:44 and repeat 5×.

4 · Walkover / handstand line (~1:08)

Goal: straight legs through vertical, split shape at the top, quiet landing.

- [ ] Wrist circles first. Belly-to-wall handstand 3×10–15 sec.
- [ ] Kick up to vertical with straight legs, 5×. Then open to a split at the top, 5×.
- [ ] Kick-overs **only** on the mat with a spotter until cleared in class.

5 · Floor kick (~1:42)

Goal: height from the hip, not the back; pointed foot at the top.

- [ ] 8 slow kicks each side, 4 counts up, 4 down. Point at the top.
- [ ] Cue: **kick from the hip, keep the back long.**
- [ ] Hamstring stretch after (not before) the kicks.

6 · Passé turns (~1:50)

Goal: toe to the side of the knee, high relevé, sharp spot, arms round.

- [ ] Passé balance on relevé, 10 sec, both sides. Wobble = try again, not step down.
- [ ] Quarter turns ×8, half turns ×8, then singles ×10 each side.
- [ ] Put a sticker on the wall and spot it. Arms hug a big beach ball.

7 · The ending (1:53–2:00)

Goal: the shape holds, breathing but still, until the music is completely gone.

- [ ] Play the last 15 seconds of the real track 5×. Hold. Count 8 more after you think it's over.
- [ ] Face stays in the story. No looking up, no smile-and-relax until the music is gone.

8 · Donut roll (after the walkover)

Goal: a round, open donut shape: arms down, head ALL the way back. Never tuck the chin.

- [ ] Warm the back: cobra, then seal stretch, 20 sec each.
- [ ] Kneeling backbend, hands to heels, 3×5 sec. Bridge holds 3×10 sec.
- [ ] Donut shape: knees bent, chest open, eyes to the ceiling, then the wall behind.
- [ ] Roll: **head ALL the way back.** Cue: chest leads, eyes follow.

How to practice a trick

- **Slow first.** Do it at half speed 3× before full speed.
- **Film one.** Watch it. Compare with the picture in your head.
- **Fix one thing.** Not three. One.
- **Then put it back in the dance** with the counts before and after it.
- **Stop before tired.** Tired tricks teach bad habits.